

You know what made me confident about money? Becoming competent with it.

- » I learned my numbers so I knew how much I was earning, how much I was spending, and how much I was saving and investing.
- » I changed my money behaviors. I set up automated money flows so that my money got invested without me doing anything.
- » I started spending on the things I loved and cut back on the things I didn't.
- » I stopped worrying about small expenses and created a Worry-Free Number (we'll learn more on page 158).
- » I got comfortable with the idea of making mistakes, accepted that they're inevitable, and understood that I will find ways to recover from them.

Now, let's acknowledge an obvious truth: It's much easier to be confident with money when you have enough. That's why I wrote *I Will Teach You to Be Rich* in the first place!

But I can tell you that merely accumulating more money will not change the way you *feel* about it. I know many, many multimillionaires who are still consumed with hot emotions about their money, like guilt, jealousy, anger, and shame.

I consider that a tragedy. Why? Because a Rich Life is lived outside the spreadsheet. In addition to earning and investing money, you have to be confident enough to remain cool and to use that money to create your Rich Life.

Money confidence is knowing that a \$68 ticket won't hobble you. It's knowing that sometimes to be a good friend, you shut up and happily pay for dinner. And it's knowing that you can build confidence through competence. Without that money confidence, you can grow your bank account, but you'll always feel scarcity.

My trainer once said that he wanted me to be able to walk into any gym and do any exercise. I want the same thing for you with money: I want you to be so confident with your money, you can handle anything life throws at you.